

THE ATHLEADER PLAYBOOK

Lesson 2

Pre-Season Conditioning

Inner Blueprint Discovery

About 60 minutes of reps this week. Your core rep, Drill 2.1, takes about 15.

M.V.P. Accelerator™

POWERED BY ATHLEADERSHIP ARENA™

LESSON 2

Pre-Game Huddle: Your Focus for Lesson 2

Welcome to your Pre-Season Conditioning. In the Arena, victory isn't just about what you do; it's about who you are. This lesson is your dedicated time to conduct a "scouting report" on yourself. The self-awareness you build here (understanding your values, strengths, energy, and key life moments) is the foundation for authentic and powerful leadership.

This is the discovery phase. Give yourself the space to be honest and insightful. The work you do here provides the "raw materials" you will use to architect your M.V.P. Blueprint in Lesson 3.



Primary A.R.A.W. Focus:

Wellbeing

Cultivating deep self-awareness is the first step to managing your energy and sustaining peak performance.

Resilience

Understanding your past challenges and successes builds the mental and emotional muscle to navigate future pressure.

Your Objectives for this Lesson:

- Identify 3-5 non-negotiable Core Values that act as your leadership compass.
- Distinguish between learned skills and true, energizing strengths.
- Conduct a personal Energy Audit to identify what fuels you and what drains you.
- Review your personal "Game Tape" to extract critical lessons from past experiences.

START HERE

Drill 2.1: Discover Your Core Values

Your core rep this week, about 15 minutes.

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Video Debrief Zone

Use this space to capture key ideas, “aha” moments, and powerful quotes from Melissa’s coaching in the Lesson 2 videos. What resonated most with you?

Key Idea 1 (My Core Values):

Key Idea 2 (My Strengths & Energy):

Key Idea 3 (My “Game Tape”):

LESSON 2 · ABOUT 60 MINUTES OF REPS THIS WEEK

A.R.A.W. Conditioning Drills

This is where you start putting in the reps.

Drill 2.1
CORE REP · START HERE
Discover Your Core Values
Alignment
15 min
Page 5 ›

Drill 2.2
EXTRA REP, IF YOU HAVE TIME
Identify Your Strengths
Wellbeing
15 min
Page 6 ›

Drill 2.3
EXTRA REP, IF YOU HAVE TIME
Your Energy Audit
Wellbeing
15 min
Page 7 ›

Drill 2.4
EXTRA REP, IF YOU HAVE TIME
Review Your "Game Tape"
Resilience
15 min
Page 8 ›

Fill it in on screen. Type straight into the grey boxes and tick the boxes that apply. Save the file to keep your answers.

Or on paper. Print the pages and write by hand.

Then get feedback. Run your core rep, then ask one person how it landed.

Drill 2.1 | Core rep · start here | About 15 minutes

Discover Your Core Values

Your values are your personal "True North." They guide your decisions when the path forward is unclear. The goal here is not to create a long list, but to identify the three to five values that are absolutely essential to who you are.

Instructions: Review the list of values below. Check all that resonate with you. Then, from your checked list, narrow it down to the top five that you would follow at the expense of all others. Write those five in "My Core Values," and mark the three you'd hold even when it costs you.

Values List Sampler

- ☐ Accountability
- ☐ Achievement
- ☐ Adventure
- ☐ Alignment
- ☐ Authenticity
- ☐ Balance
- ☐ Belonging
- ☐ Boldness
- ☐ Challenge
- ☐ Community
- ☐ Compassion
- ☐ Competence
- ☐ Confidence
- ☐ Connection
- ☐ Contribution
- ☐ Courage
- ☐ Creativity
- ☐ Curiosity
- ☐ Discipline
- ☐ Empathy
- ☐ Excellence
- ☐ Fairness
- ☐ Faith
- ☐ Family
- ☐ Freedom
- ☐ Growth
- ☐ Harmony
- ☐ Honesty
- ☐ Humility
- ☐ Impact
- ☐ Innovation
- ☐ Integrity
- ☐ Joy
- ☐ Justice
- ☐ Kindness
- ☐ Knowledge
- ☐ Leadership
- ☐ Loyalty
- ☐ Mastery
- ☐ Openness
- ☐ Optimism
- ☐ Passion
- ☐ Patience
- ☐ Peace
- ☐ Perseverance
- ☐ Recognition
- ☐ Respect
- ☐ Responsibility
- ☐ Security
- ☐ Service
- ☐ Spirituality
- ☐ Stability
- ☐ Strength
- ☐ Success
- ☐ Teamwork
- ☐ Trust
- ☐ Truth
- ☐ Vision
- ☐ Wealth
- ☐ Wisdom

My Core Values:

1. _____ ☐ Top 3
2. _____ ☐ Top 3
3. _____ ☐ Top 3
4. _____ ☐ Top 3
5. _____ ☐ Top 3

My notes:

Drill 2.2 | Extra rep, if you have time | About 15 minutes

Identify Your Strengths

A strength isn't just something you're good at; it's an activity that energizes you. When you're operating from your strengths, you feel in a state of flow. Reflect on the following prompts to identify your natural advantages.

What activities make you lose track of time?

What kind of problems do you enjoy solving for others?

What are you doing when you feel most confident and effective?

What do people consistently compliment you on or come to you for help with?

After which activities do you feel more energized than when you started?

Drill 2.3 | Extra rep, if you have time | About 15 minutes

Your Energy Audit

Energy, not time, is your most valuable currency. Identifying your “drains” and “fuels” is the first step toward managing your energy for peak performance.

Use last week’s calendar, not an ideal week.

Identify Your Drains: List three to five people, tasks, or environments that consistently drain your energy.

» _____

» _____

» _____

» _____

» _____

Example

Weekly 2-hour status report meeting.

Identify Your Fuels: List three to five people, tasks, or environments that consistently energize you and fuel your passion.

» _____

» _____

» _____

» _____

» _____

Example

One-on-one mentoring session with my direct report.

Alignment Summary Grid

Now, synthesize your discoveries from the drills above.

Element	Currently Aligned? (Y/N)	What’s Working?	What’s Missing or Misaligned?
My Core Values	○ Y ○ N		
My Strengths	○ Y ○ N		
My Energy	○ Y ○ N		

Drill 2.4 | Extra rep, if you have time | About 15 minutes

Review Your “Game Tape”

Your past experiences hold the data for your future success. We look back not with judgment, but with the curious eyes of a Player-Coach.

Peak Performance Moment

Describe a specific time in your life or career when you were “in the zone” and performing at your absolute best. What was the situation? What were you doing? What made it a success? What strengths were you using?

Resilience Moment

Describe a time you faced a significant challenge or setback. How did you feel, and what actions did you take to navigate through it or bounce back? What did you learn about your resilience from this experience?

Change Navigation Reflection

Think of a recent change you navigated. What value or strength helped you? What blind spot did this situation reveal?

Locker Room Reflection

After completing the drills for this lesson, what is the single most important insight you've gained about your Inner Blueprint? How will you apply this insight in how you lead yourself, and others, in the next 30 days?

Think about a recent season of high change or transition (merger, reorg, personal loss, promotion, etc.). How did your values, energy, or strengths show up, or not? What would you do differently now using this Inner Blueprint?

Quick Self-Check

Just for you. Your Pulse Check, the one that tracks your season, is in the course.

On a scale of 1 to 10, how equipped do you feel to lead yourself through change after this reflection?

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Get Feedback

Run your core rep, then ask one person how it landed: your Player-Coach, a peer, someone on your team.

Who I asked: _____

What they said, and what I'll keep doing:

Back in the course: your Athleader Pro Huddle with Dr. Michael Mannino, then your Pulse Check.